

SA Junior Chess League
2024 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP
PROBLEM SOLVING
UNDER 12 ADELAIDE

NAME: _____ DATE OF BIRTH _____

AGE GROUP (Please Circle)

U8 (Born 2016 or after)

U10 (Born 2014 or after)

U12 (Born 2012 or after)

GENDER (Please Circle) BOY GIRL

You will have up to **2 HOURS** to complete the problem solving paper. Questions are in order of estimated difficulty, easiest first. You may do them in any order you like but it is recommended that you start at the beginning and work through in approximate order. You may use a chess board and pieces to assist in your work. Solve as many problems as you can, but there is no expectation that you will solve them all. If you do finish all questions before the 2 hours is up, hand in the paper as soon as you are finished so your finish time can be recorded. Times may be used to separate contestants with equal total marks.

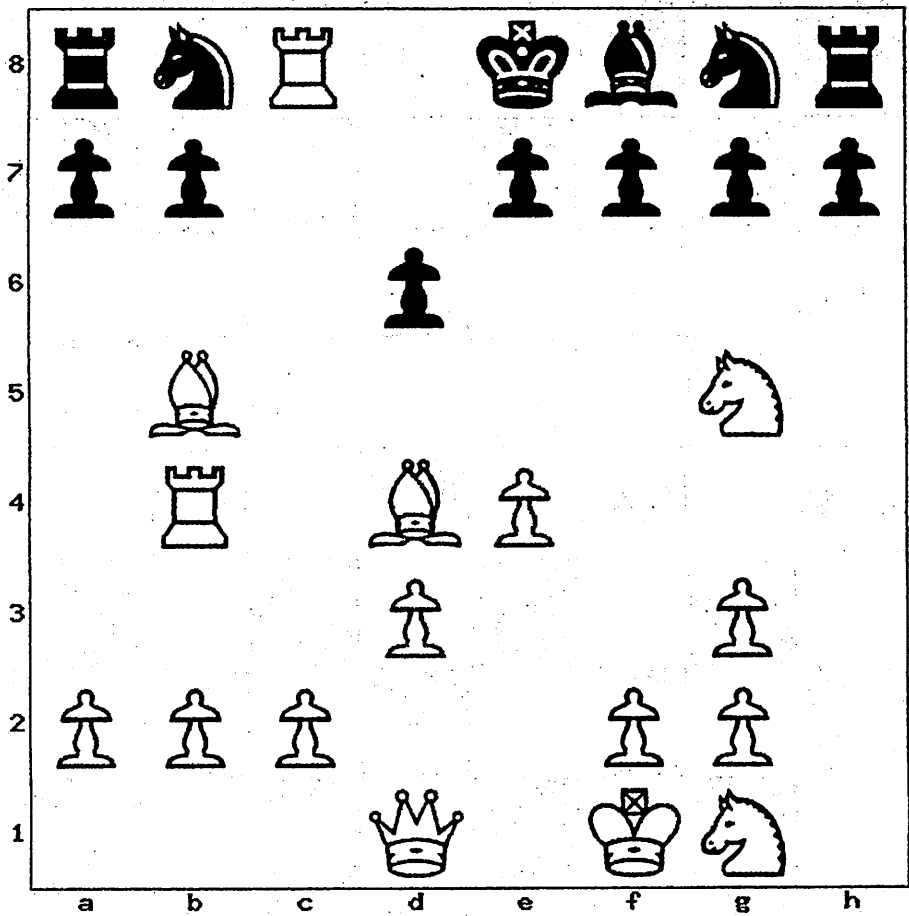
Please write your solutions in the space provided below each diagram. Use algebraic notation when writing chess moves. For mate questions, you will receive the maximum marks if you give the correct key move as well as any threats, defensive black moves and responses covering all mates. If the key move does not threaten mate in the stipulated number of moves, write (waiting) after the key move and indicate for each black move the correct white response. If the correct key move only is given you will receive at least 60% of the allocated marks. For game studies, read each question carefully, answer the specific questions asked or go far enough to reach a clearly winning or drawing position as applicable.

Partial answers may receive partial credit. The marks allocated to each question are listed in the paper and total 100.

Question 1

Noam Elkies

U.S. Problem Bulletin 1995



Who moved last, Which Piece, where to and where from? Explain your answer.
[3 Marks]

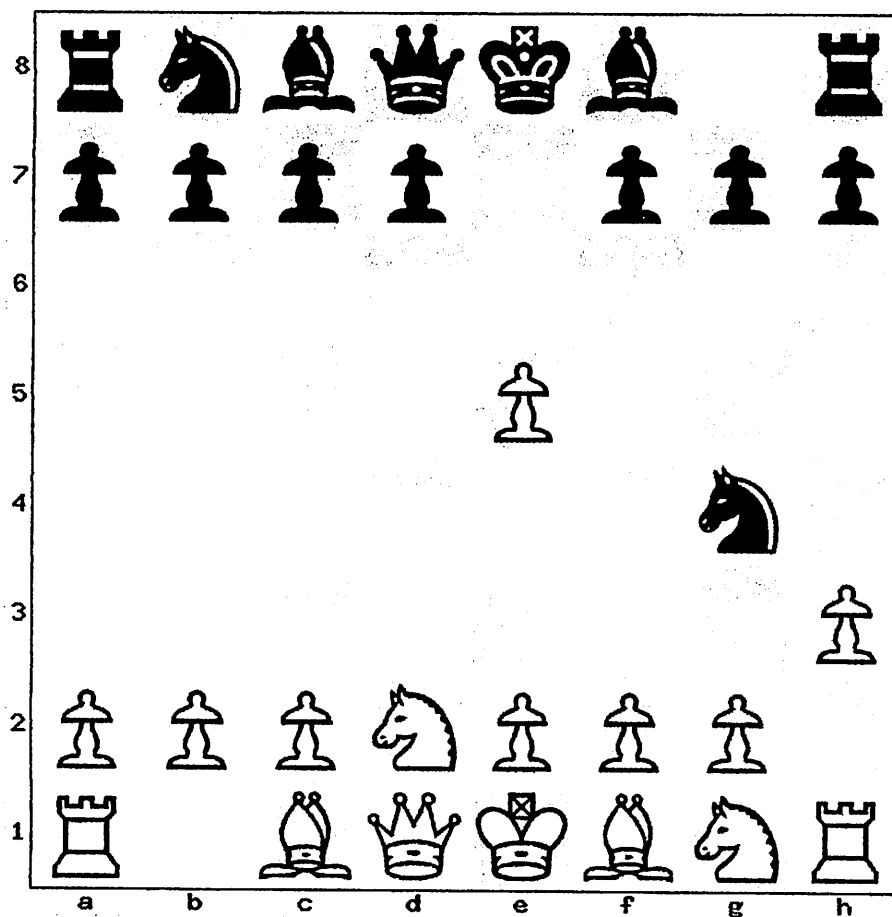
Solution

Black is in double-check(mate). It is illegal to move into check so **White** must have moved last by placing a **Rook** on **c8** giving check. The Rook must have moved from **c6** to simultaneously discover a check from the b5 Bishop.

Marks...../3

Question 2

Horowitz and Reinfeld
Chess Traps 1954



White has just played **4.h3** expecting Black's knight to recapture a pawn on e5. Black has other ideas. What did Black play and why was it better than the expected move?
[4 Marks]

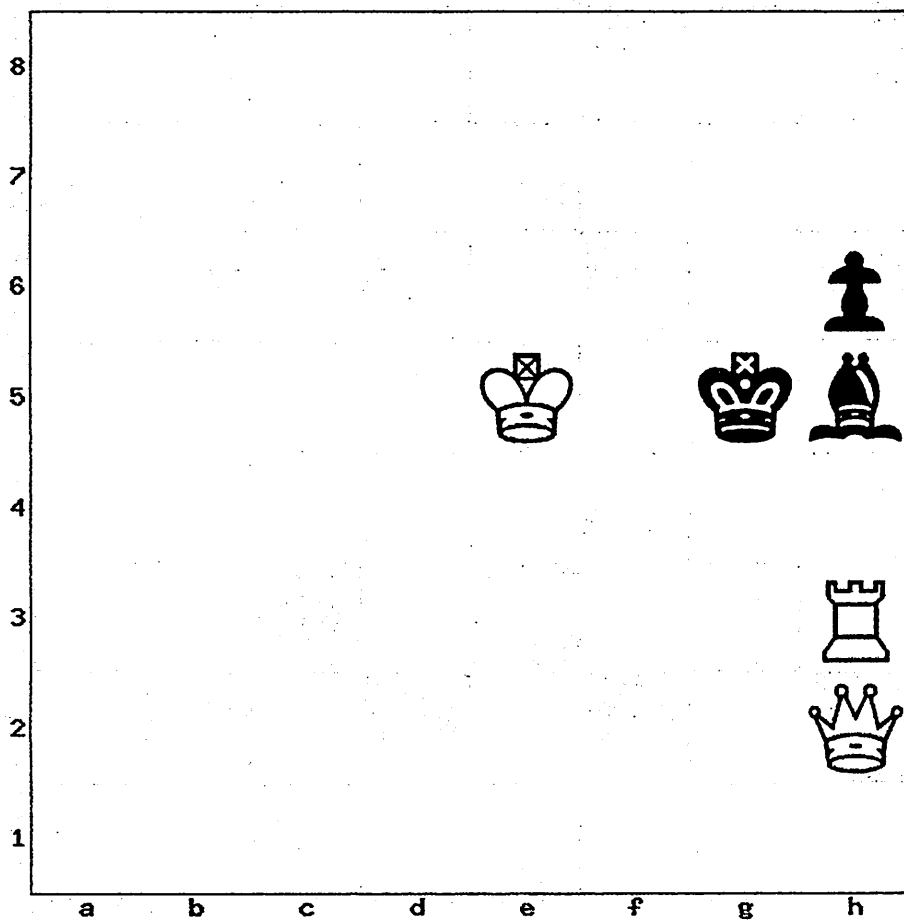
Solution

Black played **4..Ne3!!** threatening to capture white's Queen (She has nowhere to go). **5.fe** is useless because of **5..Qh4+ 6.g3 Qxg3#**

Marks...../4

Question 3

Sam Loyd 1881



White to play and Mate in 2 [7 Marks]

Solution

1.Qa2 (Waiting)

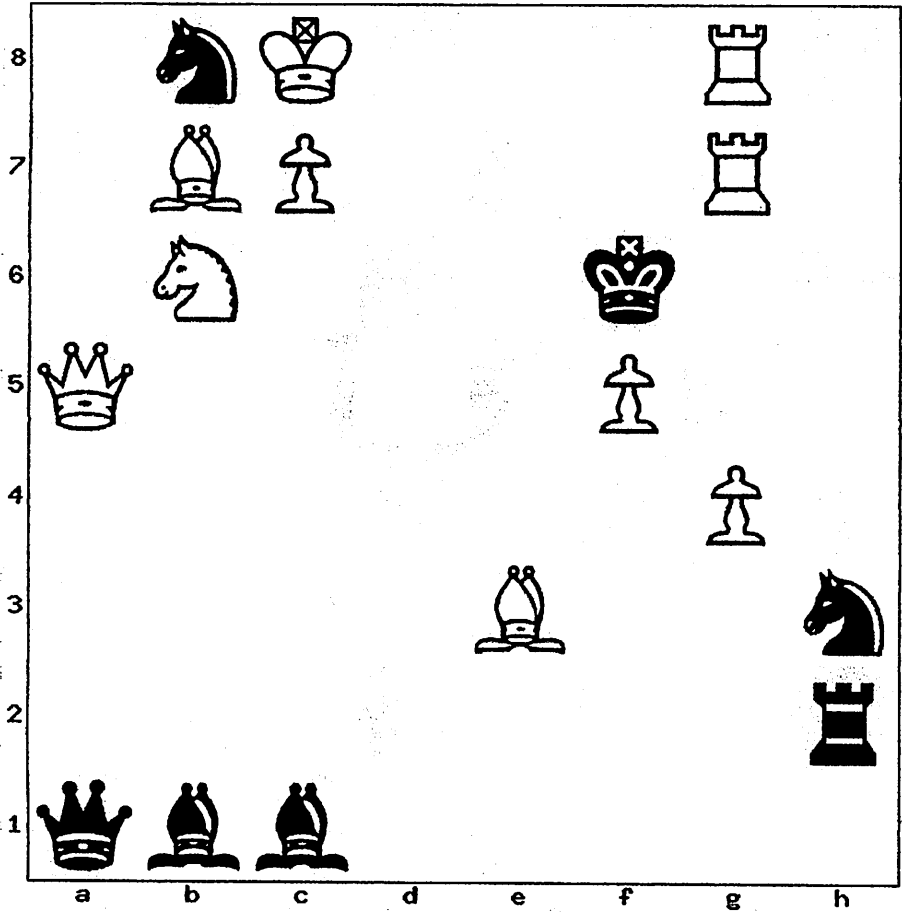
1...Kg4/Bg8/Bf7/Be8 2.Qg2

1...B else/Kg6 2.Qg8

Marks...../7

Question 4

Sam Loyd 1901



White to play and Mate in 2 [7 Marks]

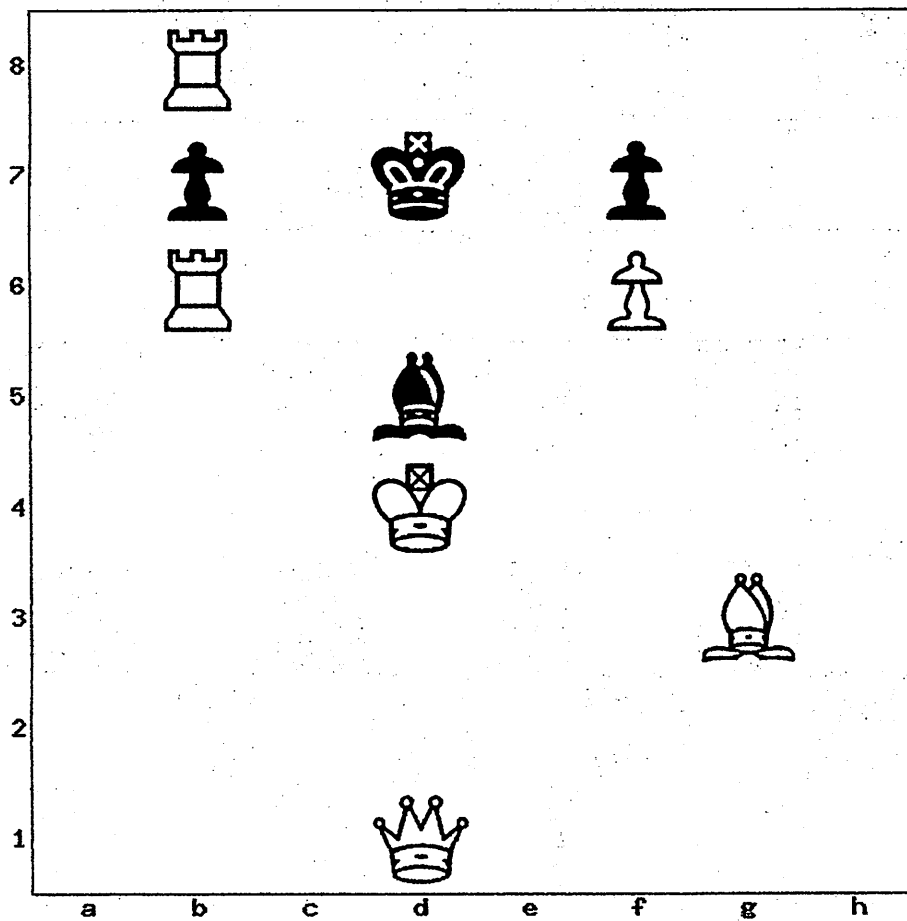
Solution

1.Qa6 (2.Nd7)
1...Qxa6 2.Bd4 1...Ke5 2.Nc4

Marks...../7

Question 5

Sam Loyd



White to play and Mate in 2 [7 Marks]

Solution

1.Qd3 (Waiting)

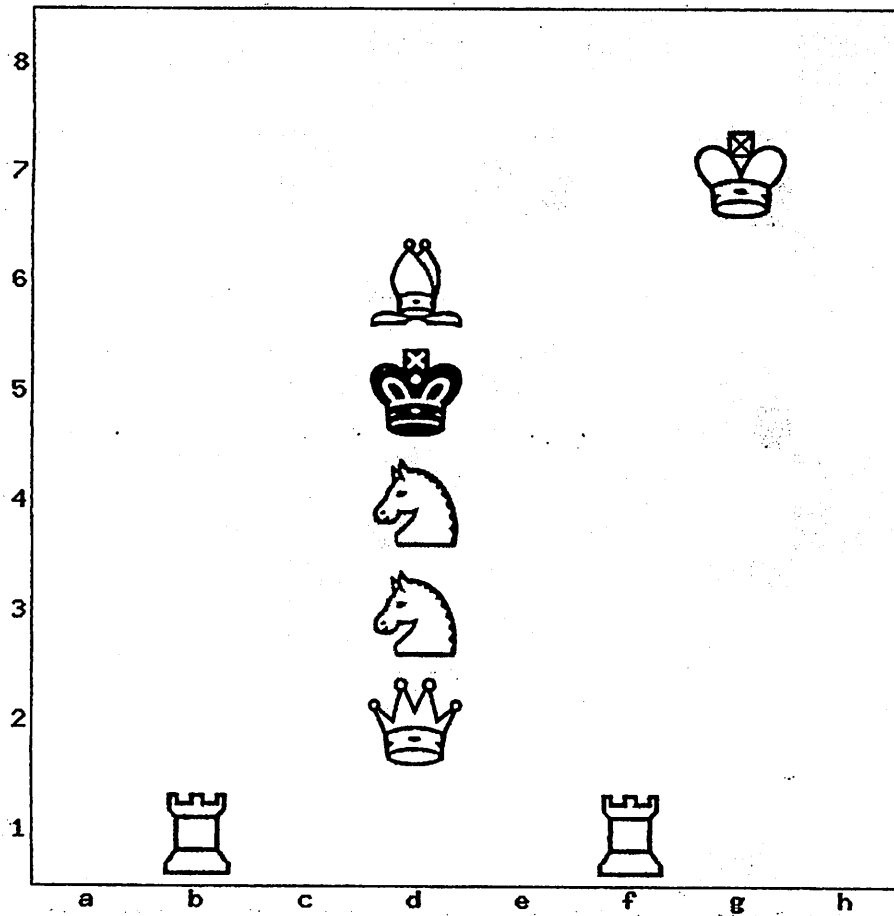
1...Be4 2.Kxe4 1...Bc4 2.Kxc4 1...Bc6/Bf3/Bg2/Bh1 2.Qf5

1...B else 2.Qb5

Marks...../7

Question 6

Sam Loyd 1877



White to play and Mate in 2 [8 Marks]

Solution

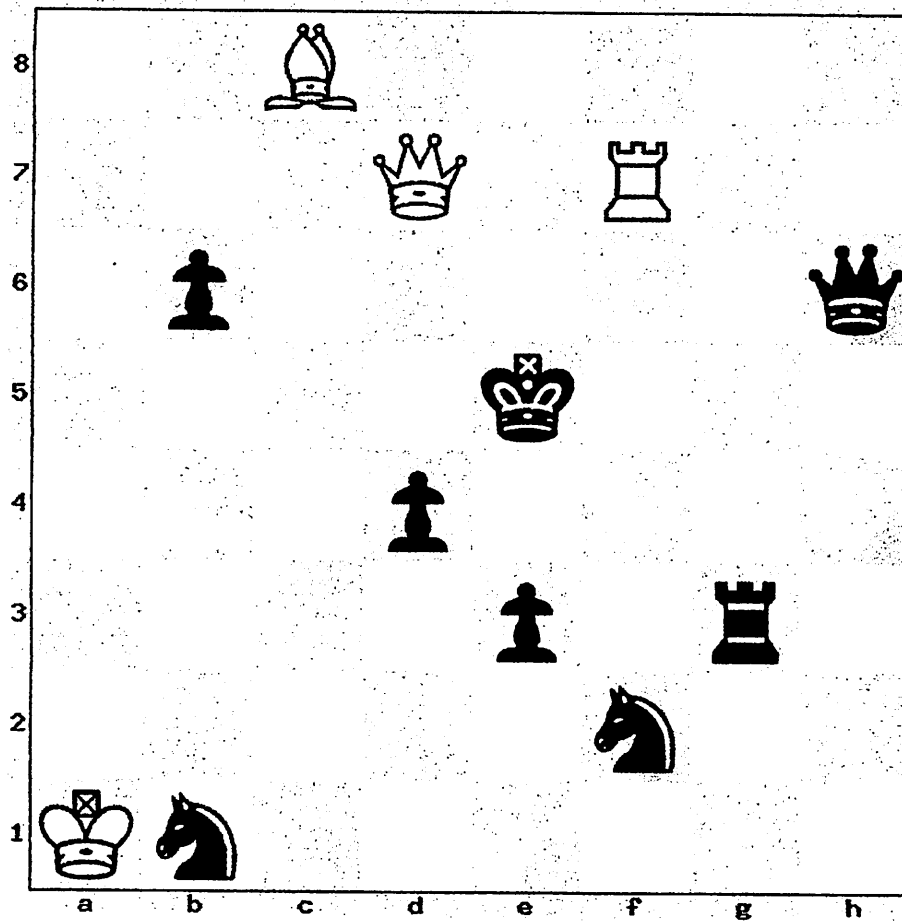
1.Nf5 (Waiting)

1...Kc6/Kc4 2.Ne5 1...Ke6/Ke4 2.Nc5

Marks...../8

Question 7

Sam Loyd



White to play and Mate in 2 [8 Marks]

Solution

1.Rf4 (2.Qxd4)

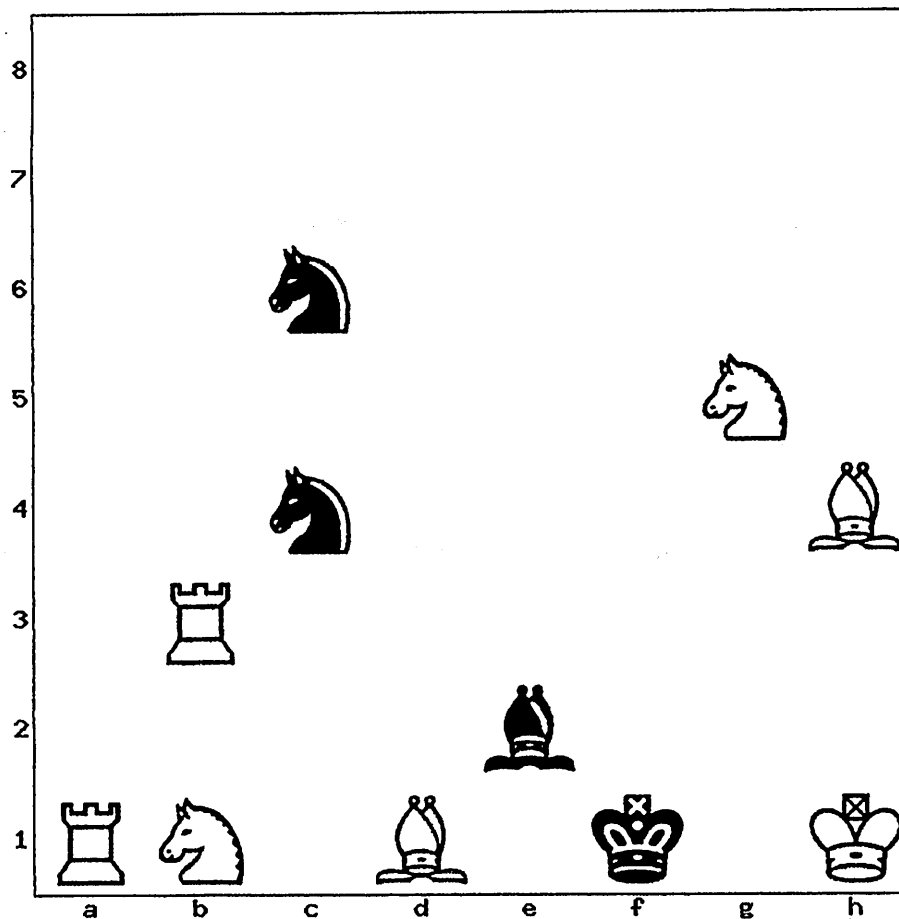
1...Kxf4/Qd6 2.Qf5 1...Qxf4 2.Qe6 1...Ne4 2.Rf5

Marks...../8

Question 8

Andy Sag

OzProblems.com 19 Aug. 2023



White to move and Mate in 2 [9 Marks]

Solution

1.Nc3! (2.Bxe2 # with double check)

1...Bxd1 2.Rxd1

1...Bf3+ 2.Bxf3 (set 2.Rxf3)

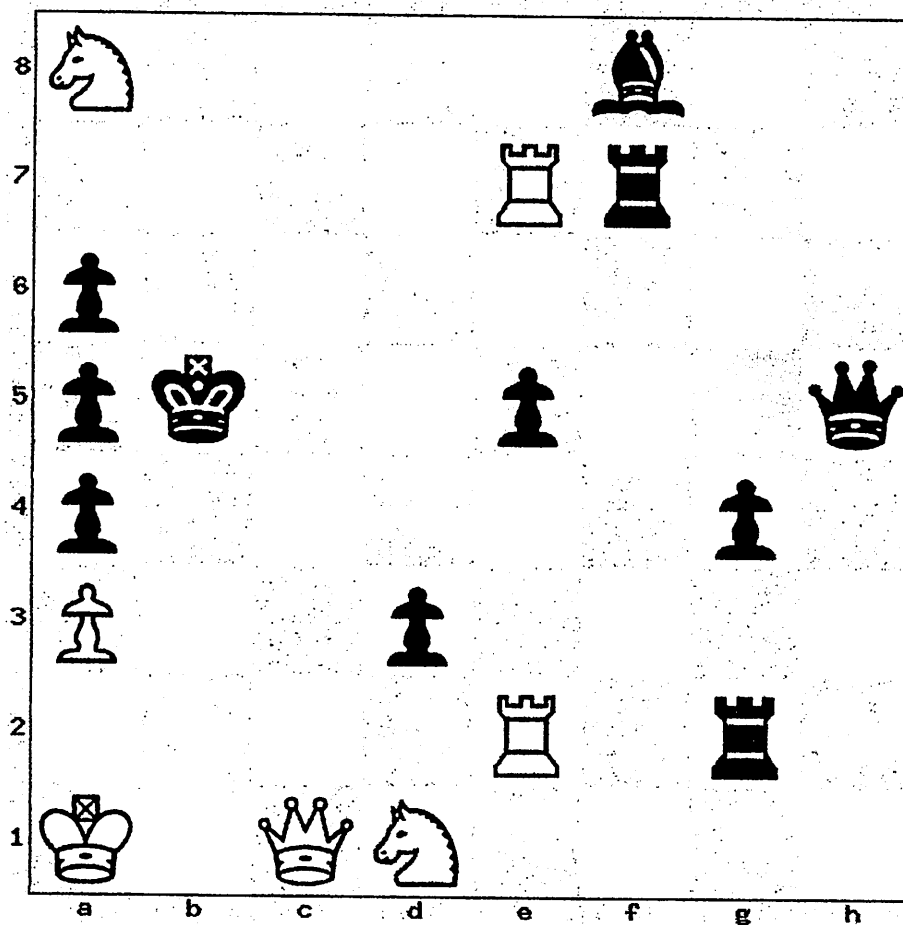
Tries: 1.Rg3? (2.Rg1) Bxd1! 1.Re3? (2.Bxe2) Nd4!

Marks...../9

Question 9

Peter Wong

The Problemist 1988, 7th Hon. Mention



White to play and Mate in 2 [9 Marks]

Solution

1.Qc8! (2.Nc3). 1...Rg1 2.Rb2, 1...Qh1 2.R2xe5, 1...Rf1 2.Rb7.

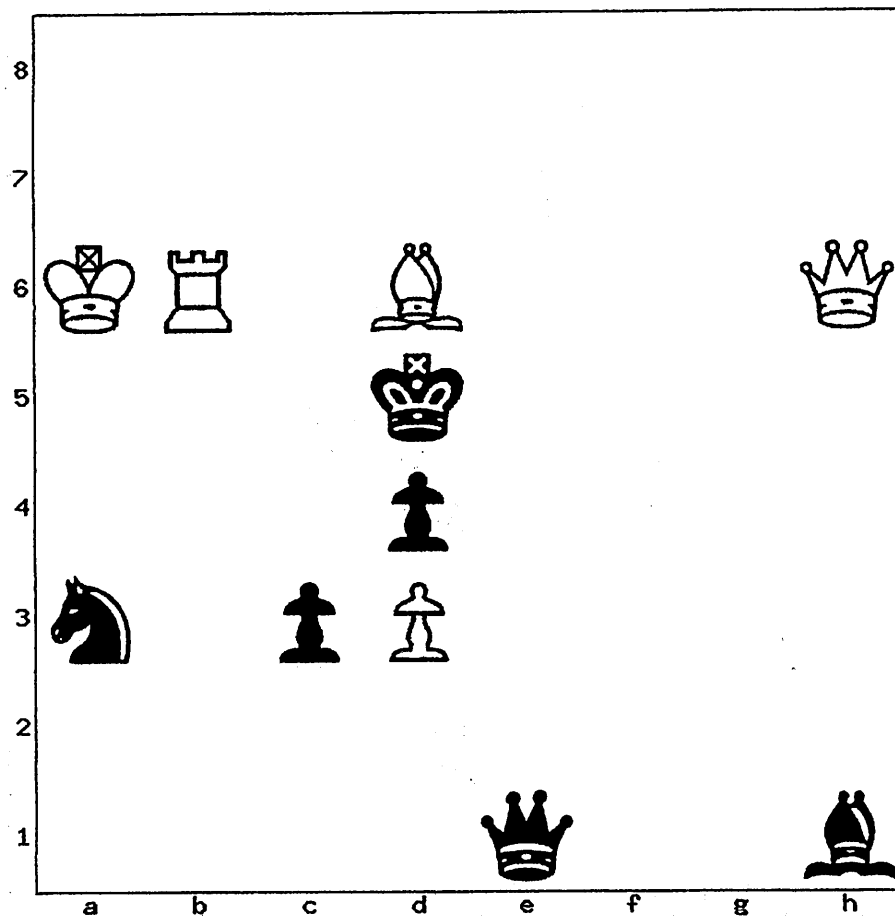
Tries: 1.Nb2? (2.Qc4) Rg1! 1.Ne3? (2.Qc4) Qh1! 1.Qc7? (2.Nc3) Rf1!

Marks...../9

Question 10

Andy Sag

OzProblems.com 7 Oct. 2023, Version by Michael McDowell



White to move and Mate in 2 [11 Marks]

Solution

1.Be5! (2.Qd6)

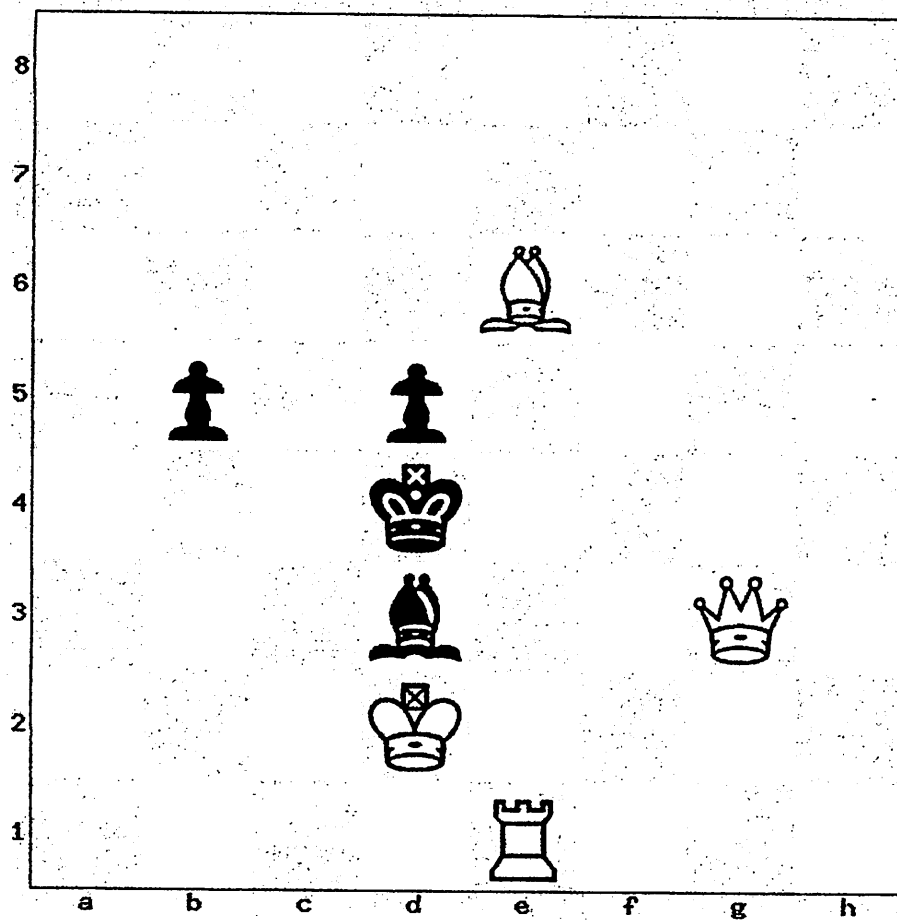
1...Qxe5 2.Qc6 1...Kxe5 2.Qg5 1...Kc5 2.Qd6 1...Nb5/Nc4 2.Rb5

Tries: 1.Bb4/Bxa3/B65/Bf8? Qe7! 1.Bb8/Bc7/Bf4? Qe6!

Marks...../11

Question 11

Sam Loyd 1858



White to play and Mate in 2 [12 Marks]

Solution

1.Re4+

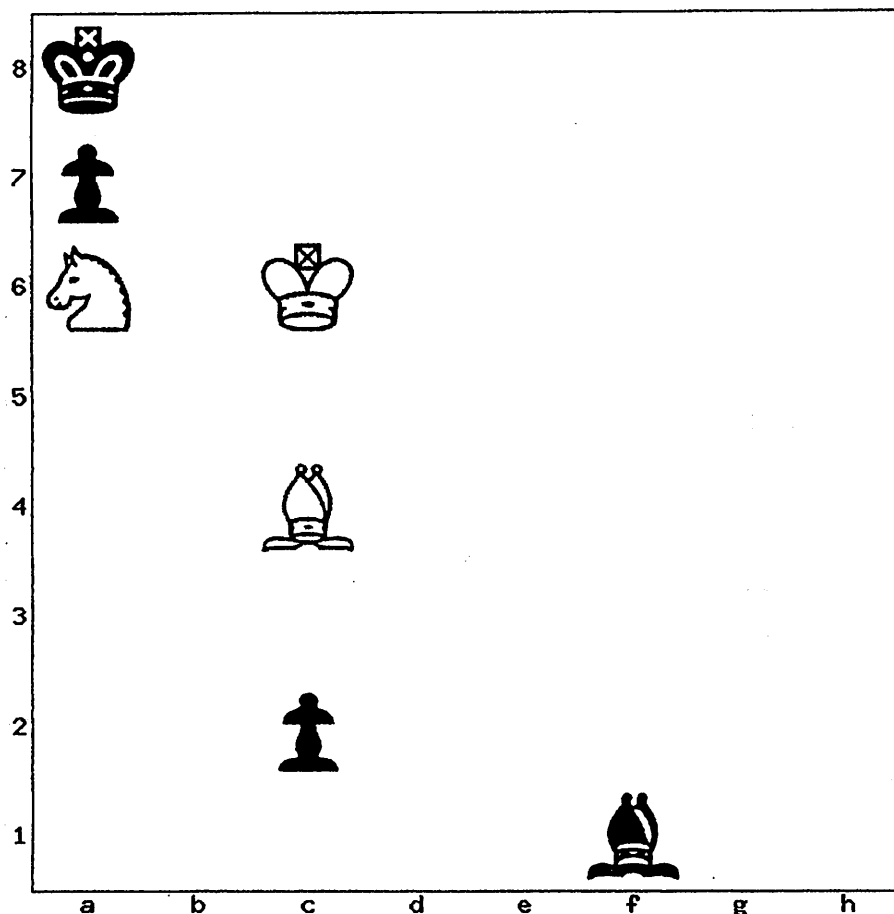
1...Kxe4 2.Qe3 1...de 2.Qd6 1...Bxe4 2.Qc3 1...Kc5 2.Qc7

Marks...../12

Question 12

Bernardus Postma

Parallèle 50 1948, 1st Hon. Mention



White to play and Mate in 6 [15 Marks]

Solution

1.Bd5! (2.K any#)

1...c1=Q+ 2.K~+ Qc6+ 3.Bxc6#

1...Bg2 2.Bxg2 c1=Q+ 3.K~+ Qc6+ 4.Bxc6

1...Bxa6 2.Kc7+ Bb7 3.Bxb7

1...Bc4, 2.Bg2 Bf1 3.Bh1 3...c1=Q+ 4.Kd6/Kd7+ Bg2 5.Bxg2+ Qc6+ 6.Bxc6

3...Bg2 4.Bxg2 c1=Q 5.Kd6/Kd7+ Qc6 6.Bxc6

Marks...../5